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Tax Information & Resources for F-1 International Students

Sayre Weir
Updated Monday, March 16, 2026
International Student Engagement

IT'S TAX TIME!

**All international students have a tax filing responsibility according to US Law.*

Federal & State Tax Filing Deadline:

April 15, 2026

***All tax filing paperwork must be printed, signed, mailed, and postmarked no later than this date**

The information in this news article is intended only for F-1 visa-holding international students in preparation for filing their 2025 taxes during the spring 2026 semester.

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USEFUL LINKS FOR TAX SEASON

- Tax Info Workshop Guide Slides & Step-by-Step Instructions
- Sprintax Calculus (for accessing form 1042-S and beginning your tax returns)
- Oracle (for accessing form W-2)
- Sprintax Tax Prep (to begin filing your taxes once you've collected all of your documents)
- Links to Register for ISE & Controller's Office **Tax Info Workshops**
  - Wednesday, March 18 (2-3:30pm) Sprinkle Room (RSVP here)
  - Wednesday, March 25 (4:30-5:30pm) Sprinkle Room (RSVP here)
  - Tuesday, March 31 (11am-12pm) Sprinkle Room (RSVP here)
  - Wednesday, April 8 (4:30-5:30pm) Sprinkle Room (RSVP here)
  - Tuesday, April 14 (10am-2pm) Coffee & Tea & Taxes with ISE in the International Lounge (RSVP here)
- Links to Register for **Sprintax Webinars** (more info included on webinars in section below)
  - January 28 @ 12pm - Register Here
  - February 5 @ 1pm - Register Here
  - February 10 @ 7pm - Register Here
  - February 18 @ 3pm - Register Here
  - February 24 @ 10am - Register Here
  - March 5 @ 12pm - Register Here
  - March 11 @ 1pm - Register Here
  - March 16 @ 2pm - Register Here
  - March 27 @ 11am - Register Here
  - April 1 @ 1pm - Register Here
  - April 7 @ 8am - Register Here
  - April 14 @ 2pm - Register Here

U.S. TAX INFORMATION FOR CURRENT F-1 STUDENTS

If you were in the United States for even 1 day in 2025, you will have tax responsibilities this year. *Carefully read the information below and view a brief video (below) to understand your tax responsibilities.*

Do I Need to File Taxes?

YES! All international students on F- or J- visas in the U.S. for 1 day or more in 2025 will need to file at least 1 document with the U.S. Internal Revenue Service (IRS). Read below to find the information relevant to your specific situation.

Situation A: Students without US Income

If you did not receive any US income, non-qualified scholarship, or grant in 2025:*

- Your only requirement is to complete form 8843 and mail to the IRS address per form instructions
- You can find the 8843 directly on the IRS website or through Sprintax
- Your travel history (select "View Travel History at this link) will be very helpful for this
- When? You may complete this now and it must be mailed to the Internal Revenue Service no later than April 15, 2026. All international students can pick up personalized return labels, envelopes, and mailing guides at Tax Info Workshops or from the ISE office beginning in mid-March. You will be charged for postage and the envelope when you mail your materials at the Campus Post Office.

Situation B: Students with US Income (Employment income, non-qualified scholarships*, or grant income)

Any F-1 international student who received any US-based income, "non-qualified" scholarship(s) (funds other than tuition, fees, and books), or grants in 2025:*

- You are legally required to file a tax return even if you are not currently in the United States.
- How? Once Davidson College has issued all tax-related documents, ISE will send information on how to file for free and get assistance via webinars, live chat, etc.
- When? Tax returns must be mailed no later than April 15, 2026 but DO NOT SUBMIT your return until you are certain all tax documents have been received which is usually in early March.
- What should I do now?
  - Watch your mail and email for notifications from Davidson and any employers you may have had with tax-related documents (W-2, 1099, 1042-S, etc.). When you receive these, save these in a safe place as you will need them to complete your tax return documents.
  - Watch your email for more information in March and early April for information about free tax filing support, webinars and workshops.

*Non-qualified scholarship may be in the form of grants or financial aid beyond tuition, fees, and books. Unsure if you received a "non-qualified" scholarship from Davidson in 2025? Contact Boo Luther in the Controller's Office at boluther@davidson.edu to inquire. Please put "non-qualified scholarship?" in the subject line

Where do I find my Tax Documents? And who do I Contact with Questions?

While ISE is sharing this information, ISE staff are not qualified tax professionals and cannot give tax advice. Here are tips on who to contact, depending on the question you have.

For questions about or to locate:

Tax documents related to scholarships, grants, or on-campus employment (W-2, 1042-S, 1099, etc.)

- Davidson W-2's are available through Oracle, on the "Me" tab and the ADP link
- 1042-S forms will be distributed via Sprintax Calculus to students who had scholarship or grant income sometime in March.
- Questions or trouble accessing? Contact the Davidson Controller's Office

Income and tax forms from a CPT internship (W-2, 1099, etc.)

- Contact your employer's Human Resources (HR) department

Most other tax questions

- Sprintax's extensive video library on YouTube
- Sprintax FAQs
- Sprintax webinars (see below for schedule)
- Sprintax's live chat feature or hello@sprintax.com

Use Sprintax to Prepare Your Tax Returns

What is Sprintax?

Davidson College works with a tax software called Sprintax to assist students with the processing of their tax return forms. Sprintax will guide you through the tax preparation process, arrange the necessary documents and check if you're due a tax refund.

As long as you are still considered a non-resident for tax purposes, ISE provides a code so you can access Sprintax free of charge for currently enrolled Davidson (F-1) students (see "Get Started with Sprintax" below) and $40 for international (F-1) alumni. Even if you didn't work or receive income in the US, you're still required to file a Form 8843 with the IRS. This form can be completed with or without Sprintax.

Assistance for Resident F-1 Students and Non-F-1 Students

Unfortunately, ISE is not able to offer assistance to "residents for tax purposes" (U.S. citizens, dual-nationals, U.S. permanent residents, students on visas other than the F-1, or F-1s who have been in the U.S. long enough to be considered "residents for tax purposes"). If you begin with Sprintax and it informs you that you are a Resident for tax purposes, you will not be able to use Sprintax and instead, can use any number of free on-line tools for filing taxes or use Sprintax's partner software, TurboTax. This may incur a fee for use that will be your responsibility.

Getting Started With Sprintax

First, Gather Your Documents:

Before beginning the process of accessing Sprintax to file your taxes, make sure to have the following on-hand:

- Your passport
- Your current F-1 or J-1 visa
- Your most-recent I-94 record and Travel History Results, which you can print from this site
  - This will help Sprintax determine your residency for tax purposes
- Any and all 2025 W-2s and/or 1099s and/or 1042-S forms (issued for non-qualified scholarships and grants)
  - ****Check your W-2 for your SSN. If you did not report your SSN to HR, your W-2 will have your Davidson ID on it. If your W-2 has your Davidson ID and NOT your SSN, ensure that HR has your SSN on file and you should receive a corrected W-2 ("W-2C") in February that you will also need to include in your taxes. You will need to include both the original W-2 with your incorrect ID AND your W-2C when submitting your return.*
  - If you were employed by Davidson College in 2025 you should be able to retrieve your electronic W-2 through Oracle (via the ADP link on the "Me" tab).
  - Any W-2s or 1099s from any non-Davidson employers will be mailed to you, or otherwise made available to you.
  - Any forms 1042-S for non-qualified Davidson grants or scholarships would be available in Sprintax Calculus.
- Your direct deposit banking information, including your banking account and routing number. (NOT your debit or credit card number.)
- Your Social Security Number (SSN) or Individual Taxpayer Identification Number (ITIN).

DO NOT BEGIN FILING YOUR TAXES UNTIL YOU ARE CERTAIN THAT YOU HAVE ALL OF THE ABOVE. YOU MIGHT NEED TO REACH OUT TO YOUR 2025 EMPLOYERS DIRECTLY TO GET THE DOCUMENTATION YOU NEED. If you have questions about tax documentation from Davidson College, do not reach out to ISE. Instead, please contact Boo Luther (boluther@davidson.edu).

Then, Get Started with Sprintax

After gathering the required documentation:

1. Register/log-in to Sprintax Tax Prep. Click on "Log in" in the upper right of the screen, then click "Campus", find Davidson College and login using your Davidson username and password.
2. Complete the online form, inputting information from any tax documents (W-2, 1099, 1042-S, etc.) you have as instructed. If you have questions along the way, Sprintax has a chat feature to get help. After you finish your federal return, Sprintax will inform you if you need to complete a state tax return.
3. Enter the code:
   1. Federal tax and 8843: **F25DVDS200**
   2. State tax: **S25DVDS200**

    3. Enter the codes at the '*Review your order'* portion of the process.
4. Sprintax will prepare your tax return paperwork by filling out the tax forms based on the information you submit.
5. Once your tax forms are prepared,
    1. **print the documents from Sprintax single-sided** (there will likely be 2 sets of documents- one for Federal taxes and one for State taxes and 2 copies of each- one to mail and one to keep for your records)
    2. **read and follow al instruction pages carefully**
    3. **sign in every place** where it says to
    4. **include copies of all documents (W-2s, 1042-Ss, 1099s, etc.)** as instructed
    5. **mail your documents no later than April 15th**.
        1. Note: some students will have the option to e-file their federal tax return. If given this option, you can take advantage of this. If not, you must mail your federal return to the IRS. NC state returns must always be submitted by mail.
    6. **If you owe money** to the government, follow the instructions to make a payment by the stated deadlines.
6. Save a copy of the Sprintax documents in a safe place for future reference.

File by the Deadline

The federal deadline to file taxes is April 15. However, we recommend that you complete your filing earlier than that.

Get Assistance Via Tax Filing Resources and Webinars
Sprintax is designed to be intuitive and self-guided. However, you will need to take the necessary time to read instructions, and view Sprintax YouTube videos , and read Sprintax FAQs. If you have questions as you go, use the 24/7 chat support offered to you through Sprintax.

Webinars (Virtual)

You can attend one of the following webinars hosted by Sprintax (all times are in U.S./Canada EST). You can find links to register for all the webinars here:

- January 28 @ 12pm - Register Here
- February 5 @ 1pm - Register Here
- February 10 @ 7pm - Register Here
- February 18 @ 3pm - Register Here
- February 24 @ 10am - Register Here
- March 5 @ 12pm - Register Here
- March 11 @ 1pm - Register Here
- March 16 @ 2pm - Register Here
- March 27 @ 11am - Register Here
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Webinars cover:

- Sprintax overview
- An overview of tax for nonresident students and scholars
- Who must file a 2025 US tax return
- Types of income
- What tax-related forms you may receive
- Forms that need to be completed and sent to the IRS
- Terms like FICA, ITIN and Form 1098-T
- What happens if students don't file or misfile
- State tax returns

While it's possible to begin the process of filing your 2025 taxes at any time, we recommend waiting until ***after*** you view a Sprintax tax webinar and ensure you have received ALL tax documents.

Tax Info Workshops (In Person)

The Controller's Office and ISE are hosting tax info workshops to support you with the tax filing process. Reserve your spot using the registration links below. Dates are:

- Wednesday, March 18 (2-3:30pm) Sprinkle Room (RSVP here)
- Wednesday, March 25 (4:30-5:30pm) Sprinkle Room (RSVP here)
- Tuesday, March 31 (11am-12pm) Sprinkle Room (RSVP here)
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Frequently Asked Questions

My Social Security Number (SSN) is not on my W-2. Instead it has my student ID number. What should I do?

Make sure to put your Social Security Number in Sprintax when it prompts you for it, and make sure to include it on your W-2 section in Sprintax. Please connect with Human Resources so that they can update your employment record and put your Social Security Number on your tax documents moving forward.

Sprintax is telling me that I need to request a refund from my employer due to FICA being withheld from my paycheck. What should I do?

If you are a non-resident for tax purposes, you may be exempt from FICA tax. Learn more in this Sprintax Blog post. Please connect with your employer's Human Resources office and inquire if your W-2 is correct if FICA taxes have been withheld. If Davidson College is your employer and

your W-2 shows that Social Security and Medicare taxes have been withheld, please send one email to Boo Luther (boluther@davidson.edu), Ramona Davis (radavis@davidson.edu), and Ashley Smalls (assmalls@davidson.edu) requesting they issue you a corrected W-2 and update your records with the College.

I've completed my Sprintax process online and have downloaded my forms! What happens next?

After downloading your Sprintax-generated packets, make sure to print single-sided and read the cover sheets with instructions for both your Federal and State packets. You'll need to follow those instructions carefully, including signing your forms, gathering all additional documents, and then putting the complete packet (take note of which pages say "do not mail") in the mail to the addresses specified by the stated deadline.

Where can I pick up mailing supplies to mail my taxes?

Envelopes, mailing labels, and mailing guides will be available at all ISE & Controller's Office Tax Info Workshops. Outside of designated workshop times, you can pick up mailing materials from the International Lounge located on the first floor of Duke Hall. Once you've packed your envelopes, you can purchase postage and mail from the Campus Post Office.

When are taxes due? What happens if I miss the deadline?

All taxes must be postmarked no later than **April 15, 2026**. Read the FAQ entitled *"What if I miss the filing deadline and file late, or do not file at all?"* on this Sprintax website if you miss the filing deadline.

Can I meet with ISE or the Controller's Office for help filing my taxes?

ISE and Controller's Office staff are not licensed tax professionals and are not qualified to provide tax advice beyond connecting students to tax resources. To help manage the volume of requests during tax season, we kindly ask that students with tax questions first attend a tax info workshop, review the Tax Info Workshop Guide, and utilize the Sprintax Live Chat function before booking a meeting with ISE or Controller's Office staff to discuss tax questions.

Thanks for Reading This Far!

If you have any logistical questions such as how to use the Sprintax code or if there is something process-wise that we can help with, please don't hesitate to ask. However, if the question is specifically related to filing taxes, how to answer a question, etc., please use the Sprintax 24/7 live chat feature. ISE and the Controller's Office are not qualified to give tax advice -- that is why we partner with Sprintax.

Thanks and best wishes!

The International Student Engagement and the Controller's Office Teams

Discussion

K Kerem Atas

Write a message

CANCEL POST